LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 38 · October 26, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 38: the tail of the drill-and-coin sugya (Beit Shammai vs Beit Hillel on how much of a skull must be missing), Chizkiyah Avi Akesh's beraita on vessels without an interior and the rabbinic heker that saves terumah from being burnt by mistake, and the opening of the eye-blemish catalogue — haris, dak, tevalul, chilazon and nachash, and the eighty-day tests for fixed conditions.

טומאת משקין דרבנן · THE TERUMAH THAT CAN NEITHER BE BURNT NOR EATEN



1. Chazal made rabbinic liquid-tumah behave like earthenware tumah — inside spreads out, outside stays outside — so that you'd have a visible heker. Otherwise you'd face an impossible choice with terumah that touched the vessel.

“Burn it? Mideoraita it's tahor terumah. Eat it? Miderabbanan it's tamei. So you gotta leave it.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 38a · עבדו רבנן היכירא — Chazal made a heker so you won't burn tahor terumah · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 20:15

מדרס · WHY EARTHENWARE CAN'T BE A ZAV'S SEAT



2. A flat wooden vessel can still become tamei mideoraita through midras — a zav could sit on a bench. So the Gemara asks: why can't a flat earthenware vessel become tamei the same way?

“אין מדרס בכלי חרס — nobody sits on earthenware, because it's just going to crack.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 38a · אין מדרס בכלי חרס — no midras by earthenware · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 23:44

אלו מומין · THE PEREK'S HEAD-TO-TOE CATALOGUE



3. Yesterday's mishnah catalogued blemishes of the ear. Today's mishnah moves on to the eye — and Elefant explains the perek's method.

“We're working with the head going downwards. First the ears, now we're down to the eyes.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 38b · הריס של עין — the mishnah moves from ears to eyes · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 29:22

LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 38 · October 26, 2026

ברקא · THE NEIGHBOR WHO CURED AWAY SUPPER



4. Tosafot says a baraka counts as a permanent mum even though Gittin gives a remedy for it — medicine doesn't turn it into a passing mum. Rav Yitzchak Zilberstein asks what happens when the cure actually happens.

“A kohen is waiting for his bechor to stay blemished so he can eat it for supper — and his neighbor, a doctor, unasked, cures the animal. Now the kohen is stuck raising it. Can he take the doctor to din Torah for the loss?”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 38b · וסימנך ברקא — the curable blemish that stays a mum · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 33:51

חלזון נחש · THE SHIUR YOU GET FOR CUTTING IN FRONT OF A SAGE



5. Rabbah bar bar Chanah reports: an old man lived in our neighborhood, Rav Shimon ben Yosi of Elkosh — and out of respect, 'I was always careful not to walk in front of him.'

“One time I was in a rush and I walked in front of him. 'Please sit down,' he said — and delivered the ruling on chilazon and nachash.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 38b · זקן אחד היה בשכנותנו — the old man in the neighborhood · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 35:22